sanas South African National Accreditation System	**MANAGEMENT REQUIREMENTS OF ISO/IEC 17025:2017**	Organisation's SANAS No/s. **TBA**

Date/s of evaluation	**4th December – 29th January 2026**
Assessor/s & Observers	**TL: Ms Charmaine Morobe and TA: Ms Nozibusiso Chiliza**
Laboratory	**Azuresky (Pty) LTD**
Area / field of operation	**Analytical laboratory of coal**
Laboratory Representative	**Ms Nonhlanhla Msibi**

This report covers the following:

Document Review only	**X**	Implementation on Site Visit only		Document Review and Site Visit		Other	

Compliance = C, Non-compliance = NC

REQUIREMENTS & COMMENTS. ***Compliance = C, Non-compliance = NC***

NB1: *References to ISO/IEC 17025:2017 are in italics & indicated as Std. The order of assessment need not follow the order of the checklist. Assessors are expected to know & have the standard, this worksheet is designed as guidance to prompt detailed recording of the process.*

REFER TO ISO/IEC 17025:2017 FOR DETAIL AND FOR CLARIFICATION NOTES.

NOTE 1: *For **CAB's comments**: The CAB must provide information on how requirements have been addressed, documented and/or implemented. Make reference to policies / procedures, incl. clause numbers.*

NOTE 2: *For **Assessor's Comments**: The Assessor must provide information on the CAB's conformity with the requirements*

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CLAUSE	ISO/IEC 17025:2017 REQUIREMENTS *How are the following addressed / implemented*	CAB's COMMENTS	C/ NC	ASSESSOR's COMMENTS
4	**GENERAL REQUIREMENTS**			
4 . 1	**Impartiality:** *How are the following addressed/implemented?*			
4.1.1	Laboratory activities undertaken impartially, structured and managed to safeguard impartiality.	• Maintain clear job descriptions and reporting lines to prevent undue influence. • Include impartiality as part of the onboarding for new employees. • There's impartiality policy ASMF 4.2  4.2. IMPARTIALITY POLICY.pdf implemented. • There's conflict of interest declaration ASMF 4.2.1 completed  4.2. 1 Conflict of Interest Declaration.p by personnel		**Addressed: Impartiality policy ASFM 4.2 Rev 00 through** • **Continuous mandatory disclosure of conflict of interest 4.2.1 Rev 00_** ***to further verify on site*****.** • **Separate commercial functions from technical decision making_ as per the organisational structure.** • **Disclosure of incentives from clients by registering them in the incentive register_** ***to further verify on site.***
4.1.2	Management's commitment to impartiality.	• Impartiality policy in place, that has a mission statement on how management commits to safeguard impartiality. See ASMF4.2. • Quality Policy has stated that Top Management is committed to impartiality. Impartiality policy has been developed.  8.2. Quality Policy Statement.pdf		**Quality policy statement ASMS 8.2 -01 acknowledge 27-07-2025 by both the Laboratory Manager and the Managing Director.**

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4.1.3	Responsibility of the laboratory to its impartiality and to ensure personnel are free form commercial, financial or other pressures that may compromise impartiality.	Within the impartiality policy document under Commitment to remaining autonomous, it reads as follows: To ensure independence and objectivity and protect impartiality risks within us as an organization and from any outside influence, the following needs to be enforced: • Continuous mandatory disclosure of conflicts of interests • Separate commercial functions from technical decision-making, ensuring that financial pressures do not affect scientific integrity. • Disclosure of incentives from clients and registering them in the incentive register form (This is to protect personnel from any undue pressure in the organisations' activities.)		• **Continuous mandatory disclosure of conflict of interest 4.2.1 Rev 00_** ***to further verify on site*****.** • **Separate commercial functions from technical decision making_ as per the organisational structure.** • **Disclosure of incentives from clients by registering them in the incentive register_ to** ***further verify on site.***
4.1.4	Identification of risks to impartiality on an ongoing basis, including those that arise from its relationships.	The lab has assessed the risks and consequences associated with impartiality as outlined by doc ASRI 4.2-001- Risk assessment to impartiality Risk assessment to impartiality.pdf		**Addressed and logged on Risk Assessment to Impartiality ASRI 4.2 -001**
4.1.5	If a risk is identified, the demonstration by the laboratory how it eliminates or minimise such risk.	There are existing controls within the ASRI 4.2-001- Risk assessment to impartiality document which highlight how each of the risks identified will be addressed should the need arise.		**Addressed and logged on Risk Assessment to Impartiality ASRI 4.2 -001**
4. 2	**Confidentiality**			

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4.2.1	Responsibility through a legally enforceable commitment for all information.	**NDA signed by all personnel see doc 4.3.1 B NON DICLOSURE CONTRACT** 4.3.1 B NON DICLOSURE CONTRAC		**Addressed: Management of Confidential information ASFM 4.3 Rev 00** • **Confidentiality agreement signed by all parties_** ***to further verify on site*****.**
	The laboratory inform customer in writing of any information it intends to place in the public domain, except for information that the customer makes publicly available.	**Covered in section 5.5. of the 4.3. Confidentiality procedure.** 4.3. CONFIDENTIALITY.pdf		**All individual concerned will be notified before disclosure.**
4.2.2	Laboratory inform the customer if it is required by law to release confidential information, unless prohibited by law.	**Covered in section 5.5. of the 4.3. Confidentiality procedure.**		***How is the laboratory intending to inform the customers*****?**
4.2.3	Confidentiality of information about the customer from sources other than the customer shall be treated as such, unless agreed by the source.	**Covered in section 5.5. of the 4.3. Confidentiality procedure.**		**Not addressed.**
4.2.4	All personnel i.e. committee members, contractors, personnel of external bodies or individuals acting on the laboratory's behalf, must maintain confidentiality.	• All Azuresky personnel signed NDA's • Visitors or contractors or sub-contractors register their attendance in the visitor's register book which has included a statement for them to manage all information obtained at Azuresky confidentially.		• **Access control _** ***to further verify on site***
5	**STRUCTURAL REQUIREMENTS**			
5.1	Legal responsibility	• The company is a legally registered entity, details of registration can be found under ASMF5 section 1		**Addressed: Structural Requirements ASFM5 Rev 00. With Co.Reg.No 2024.223777.07 currently in Business.**

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5.2	Identify management that has the overall responsibility for the laboratory.	• Responsibilities have been outlined under section 2 of the structural requirements, see doc 5 Structural Requirements • There are also job descriptions outlining the responsibilities/duties of managerial roles		**Organisational structure _ ASFM 5.1 Rev 00** • **Managing director/ Operations Manager _ Legal accountability** • **Laboratory manager and financial manager _ Ensuring compliance to the ISO/IEC 17025** • **Laboratory supervisor _ Manage physical processing, packaging and labelling of CRMs** • **Analytical chemist/technicians** • **Laboratory Operations** • **Support staff**
5.3	Define and document the range of laboratory activities.	5.3. Statement of conformity		**Addressed: Statement of conformity ASFM5.3, claims conformity to the ISO/IEC 17025 standard requirements for the following method (Whirlst the lab is not et accredited):** • **All coal and fuel analytical activities** • **Sample preparation** • **Ash** • **Volatile matter** • **Calorific value** • **MIAS determinants**
	Does the laboratory claim conformity with the standard for the range of laboratory activities, excluding externally provided lab activities on an ongoing basis.	The lab has outlined the scope of activities to which it wants accreditation for, and has also listed outsourced functions see doc 5.3. Statement of conformity		**Outsourcing of the following scopes:** • **Total Sulphur** • **Ash Fusion temperature**
5.4	Requirements of the standard, customer, regulatory authorities and organization providing recognition.			**Not addressed anywhere in the laboratory's procedures and or processes.**
	Permanent facilities, site away from permanent facilities, associated temporary or mobile facility or customer's facility.	The lab has permanent facilities in which it performs all tests (excluding subcontracted, as outlined by doc 5.3).		**17 Makriel, Unit 3 Wadeville, Germiston**

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5.5	Define structure, its place in the parent organisation and relationship between management, technical and support services.			**Organisational structure _ ASFM 5.1 Rev 00** • **Managing director/ Operations Manager _ Legal accountability** • **Laboratory manager and financial manager _ Ensuring compliance to the ISO/IEC 17025** • **Laboratory supervisor _ Manage physical processing, packaging and labelling of CRMs** • **Analytical chemist/technicians** • **Laboratory Operations** • **Support staff**
	Responsibility, authority and interrelationship of personnel who manage, perform or verify work affecting the results of laboratory activities.	• Organogram outlining the line of reporting (hierarchy) • Job descriptions outlining scope of authority as well as duties/responsibilities. • Impartiality policy in place to ensure conformity.		**Addressed in the Authority matrix** **Managing director signs off certificates (Does this refer to laboratory results as well?)** **How are technical signatories authorised to report results?**
	Document procedures to the extent necessary to ensure consistent application of lab activities.	• The lab does have procedures in place to conduct day-to-day activities		**Addressed: Document Control ASFM8.4 Rev 00** **Procedures are documented in line with the requirements of the Proficiency Testing Scheme and Reference Material production Quality Management System and to meet the requirements of international standards ISO 17025:2017; ISO 17034:2016 and ISO 17043:2023, *no mention of the Testing requirements of the ISO/IEC 17025*.**
5.6	Personnel with the authority and resources to carry out their duties:			
	Implement, maintain and improve the management system.	• Lab Manager, Lab supervisor, and Operations Manager responsible for documentation of QMS, improving it, and implementation,		**Addressed: Job Description_ Laboratory Manager ASHR 6.2.2 A, *to further verify implementation on site*.**

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	Identify deviation from the management system.	• Non-conforming work and corrective action procedure documented, see doc 7.17. Management of non-conforming work		**The referred to procedure 7.17 does not address implementation of the ISO/IEC 17025 standard, *to further verify onsite*.**
	Initiation of actions to prevent or minimize deviations.	• Improvement Action Request doc 8.7.3. used to initiate actions to prevent deviations, and identify NC work, to prevent future reoccurrence. • There are also other forms used in the root cause analysis, internal audits. Forms such as AS001MF, AS003MF , AS004MF		**The referred to document 8.7.3 does not address how the improvement action request will be carried out, *to further verify on site*.**
	Reporting to management the performance of the management system or any improvements.	• Management review meeting to be conducted at least once per year, as outlined in 8.6Management Review Procedure		**The referred to procedure does not detail how these improvements will be identified and logged, *to further verify on site*.**
5.7	Communication by laboratory management regarding the effectiveness of the management system.	• Any changes or improvements to the management system is communicated to personnel vis memorandums and/or WhatsApp group. 5.6. Azuresky memorandum template • 8.2. Quality Policy Statement also outlines the review of management system through auditing the system periodically to provide confidence in its effectiveness.		• **Monthly team meetings_ *to further verify on site*.** • **Quarterly management reviews_ *to further verify on site*** • **Email records_ *to further verify on site*** • **Customer feedback_ *to further verify on site*** • **Annual evaluation of communication effectiveness with metrics _ *to further verify on site***

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	Laboratory management ensures the integrity of the system when changes are implemented.	• Any changes or improvements to the management system is communicated to personnel vis memorandums and/or WhatsApp group. 5.6. Azuresky memorandum template		**The referred to template not submitted, *to further verify on site.***
6	**RESOURCE REQUIREMENTS**			
6.6	**Externally provided products and services**			
6.6.1	Suitable externally provided products and services that affect the laboratory are used.	• ASMF6.3. document is a checklist on what to look out for when buying, hiring, or outsourcing something that affects the quality of results or validity of test results. • A list of externally provided services as well as the suppliers ASMF 4.1 List of outsourced services		**The Referred to ASFM 6.3 not attached and not listed on the document Register Doc 6.3 R.** **Which Procedure or process details how the laboratory use suitable products or services.**
6.6.2	Procedure and records for:			
	Defining, reviewing and approving lab requirements for products and services	• Document ASMF6.2. defines the procedure for selecting, evaluating, approving, and monitoring of subcontractors.		**Addressed in the Selection, Evaluation and Monitoring ASFM 6.2 Rev 00. Approved Contractor/Subcontractor register not listing any Supplier/Service provider (list is empty)** **Selection (Screening of contractors/service providers)** • **Scope of Accreditation** • **Accreditation status** • **Past relevant experience** • **Recent Participation in Proficiency scheme.** **Will this criterion be used for both Suppliers and Service Providers?**
	Defining criteria for evaluation, selection, monitoring of performance and re-evaluation.	• Document ASMF6.2. also outlines each of these points.		**Performed annually using the ASMF 6.2C Contractor/Subcontractor Evaluation checklists** **Evaluation criteria** • **Experience or similar subcontracted work.**

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	Externally provided products and services conform to lab's established requirements.	• Checklist in place, see doc 6.2 ASMF		• **Established Operating procedures available?** • **Relevant accreditation.** • **Participation in relevant PT schemes** • **History of responsive communication** • **Allows audits?** **How does the above listed evaluation criteria monitor the performance of the Supplier and or Service Providers?** **How will the referred to ASFM 6.2B Early warning notification be used as a tool of taking action from poor supplier/service provider performance evaluations?**
	Taking action from evaluations, monitoring of performance and re-evaluations.	• An Early warning notification ASMF 6.2B is implemented to warn of slip ups by the contractor, this is to take action to prevent the ultimate negative impact. • Apply 8.7.3 Improvement action request		
6.6.3	Communication by the laboratory its requirements to external providers:			
	Products and services to be provided;	• Document ASMF6.2. mandates communication of this requirement. See page 2.		**Addressed in the Selection, Evaluation and Monitoring ASFM 6.2 Rev 00** • **The products and services to be provided?** • **The acceptance criteria?** • **Competence, including any required qualification of the organization or personnel involved?** • **Activities that the Azuresky (Pty) Ltd or its customers intend to perform at the external provider's premises?** • **Is the Azuresky (Pty) Ltd responsible to the participants or customers for the externally provided products and services** **To further verify on site.**
	Acceptance criteria;	• Checklist in place, see doc 6.2 ASMF, which will be approved by the operations manager after review. • Document ASMF6.2. mandates communication of this requirement. See page 2.		
	Competence including required qualification;	• Document ASMF6.2. mandates communication of this requirement. See page 2.		
	Activities (either lab or customer) intents to perform at the external providers premises.	• Document ASMF6.2. mandates communication of this requirement. See page 2.		
7	PROCESS REQUIREMENTS *How are the following addressed/implemented?*			
7.1	Review of request, tenders and contracts			
7.1.1	Procedure for the review of request, tenders and contracts.			

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a)	Requirements adequately defined, documented and understood.	• 4.1.2. Provides the requirements/criteria (Checklist) of acceptance for contracts , tenders, and customer requests • 4.7.1. Document outlines the requirements under section 3.2. Initial review.		**Addressed: Procedure to handle contractual matters-Review of Contracts, Tenders and Customer Requests ASFM 4.7.1 Rev 00.** **Requirements detailed in the following:** • **Customer Inquiry** • **RFQ** • **Tender document**
b)	Capability and resources to meet the requirements.	• 4.7.1. Document outlines the capability assessment under section 3.3.		**Addressed: Contractual matters-Review of Contracts, Tenders and customer Request checklist ASFM 6.1.2 with the following:** • **Include a procedure for contract review in QMS** • **Maintain records of all accepted and declined requests** • **Ensure impartiality in decision-making (avoid commercial pressure)** • **Conduct internal audits to verify contract review effectiveness** • **If a request or contract is amended after the PT scheme is underway, the same review process shall be repeated and amendments communicated to all affected parties.**
c)	Advice customer and gain approval for activities performed by external provider.	• 4.7.1. Document explains that any unclear or conflicting specifications shall be clarified in writing with the customer under section 3.4. • Contract review register 4.1.4 document to keep track of progress		
d)	Selected methods are capable of meeting customer requirements.	• Covered in the review of tenders and contracts docs 4.7.1, 4.1.2, and 4.1.4.		**To further verify on site with a completed:** • **Customer Inquiry** • **RFQ** • **Tender document**
7.1.2	Customer informed as to the method chosen.	• Customer to be informed in writing as stipulated in 4.7.1.		
7.1.3	When the statement of conformity is requested, clearly define the decision rule.	• Statement of conformity will be shown is CRM certificate, see CRM 002 certificate for example.		

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7.1.4	Differences resolved before work commences.	• Customer to be informed in writing as stipulated in 4.7.1. • There is also a deviations or comments section together with approval/acceptance by client before work commences under 4.1.4.		
7.1.5	Customer informed of any deviations from the contract.	• Covered as stated in 7.1.4. above		
7.1.6	Amendment after work commenced, review repeated, communicated to affected personnel.	• Azuresky has not yet entered into a legal agreement to provide service or receive service.		
7.1.7	Cooperation with customer in clarifying customer requests and monitoring the labs performance.	• Azuresky allows clients to come and review their own work/activities performed by the lab (i.e. audit the lab). • These requirements can also be included within the contracts that AzureSky gets into with its clients.		
7.1.8	Records maintained: reviews; significant changes; pertinent discussions with customer.	• Records to be stored for two accreditation cycles.		
7.9	Complaints			
7.9.1	Documented process: receive, evaluate and make decisions.	• Covered by document 7.18. Complaint Handling Procedure.		**Addressed: Complaint Handling procedure ASFM 7.18 Rev 01.**
7.9.2	Description of the handing process – available to any interested party on request.	• Yes, the procedure is available upon request.		**How does the laboratory plan make the complaint handling process available to interested parties?**

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	Confirm whether the complaint relates to lab activities.	• Covered under 7.18. document, under procedure steps.		**Laboratory Manager/Supervisor shall confirm whether the complaint/appeal relates to activities of production/running of PT and reference material in the organisation, What about testing activities and reported test results?** • **Complaints received in writing (*Is it in only in writing?)*** • **Received complaints are thus logged on the complaint register (not *submitted, to verify on site*)** • **Laboratory personnel will acknowledge receipt of the complaint.** • **Laboratory manager will then confirm if the complaint relates to the laboratory.** • **An investigator who is not involved in the laboratory activities will be assigned.** • **Evidence gathered for the investigations** • **Determine whether the complaint was valid. (*at which stage does the laboratory confirm if the complaint is valid or not, is it before or after assigning the investigative team*?)** • **Document the necessary corrective action.** • **Final decision taken after the review of the evidence gathered.** • **Ensuring that the investigation and decision on the complaint does not result in any discriminatory actions.**
7.9.3	Process for handling complaints: process for receiving, validating, investigation and decision on action; tracking and recording; appropriate action taken.	• Covered under 7.18. document, under procedure steps.		
7.9.4	Responsibility of the laboratory for gathering and verifying all information.	• Covered under 7.18. document, under procedure steps.		
7.9.5	Whenever possible, acknowledge receipt of the complaint, provide progress reports and the outcome.	• Covered under 7.18. document, under procedure steps.		
7.9.6	Outcome reviewed by individuals not involved in original laboratory activities.	• Covered under 7.18. document, under procedure steps.		
7.9.7	Whenever possible, give formal notice at the end of complaint.	• Covered under 7.18. document, under procedure steps.		**How does the lab plan to issue communication of the final outcome of the logged complaint?**
7.10	Nonconforming work			
7.10.1	Procedure for activities that do not conform to procedures or requirements.	• 7.17.Management of Non-conforming work		**Addressed: Management of non-conforming work: ASFM 7.17 Rev 00.**
a)	Responsibility and authorities.	• Addressed under 7.17. document section 3.		**Laboratory analyst/Operator**

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b)	Action based upon risk levels established by the laboratory.	• Risks matrix present doc 8.5. Risk Matrix		**Risk matrix used to evaluate severity and urgency, *to further verify on site with the actual completed incident report*.**
c)	Evaluation of the significance of the NC.	• Risks matrix present doc 8.5. Risk Matrix		**Risk matrix used to evaluate severity and urgency, *to further verify on site with the actual completed incident report*.**
d)	Decision taken on acceptability of the non-conforming work.	• Risks matrix present doc 8.5. Risk Matrix		**The Laboratory manager undertakes the responsibility.**
e)	Customer is notified and work re-called, where necessary.	• 7.17.Management of Non-conforming work under the procedure section.		**Ensure notification of customers and recall CRM's/RM's and certificates, *no mention of results under the testing scope*.**
f)	Defined responsibility for authorizing the resumption of work.	• Responsibilities defined, and final decision lies with the operations manager as stipulated in 7.17.Management of Non-conforming work		**Not clearly addressed int eh 7.17 Management of non-conforming work procedures.**
7.10.2	Records of nonconforming work and actions.	• NC work register see 7.10. • Use SANAS F 03-09/ AS 003MF document • Root cause analysis AS001MF • AS002MF list of possible root causes • AS004MF Brainstorming form		***No records submitted, to further verify on site.***

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7.10.3	Corrective action promptly followed, where evaluation indicates possible recurrence or doubt about compliance of the laboratory's operations with its own policies/procedures.	• Make a follow up as per SANAS F03-09		***No records submitted, to further verify on site.***
7.11	**Control of data and information management**			
7.11.1	Access to the data and information needed.	• ISO Standards available • Access to equipment and facilities such as QMWARELIMS 12		**Addressed: Data Integrity risk management and preventative maintained procedure, ASFM 7.11 Rev 00.** **The laboratory makes use of the QMWARELIMS12.**
7.11.2	LIMS: Validated for functionality. Changes such as laboratory software configuration or modification to commercial off-the shelf software – Authorised, documented and validated before implementation.	• Yes , ASMF 7.11 Data integrity risk management and preventive maintenance procedure states that "The functioning of the Laboratory Information Management System shall be validated for proper functioning of interface before implementation. Formulas, calculations and all required entries/input data is able or activated to collect, process, record, store and report." Evidence is available for perusal at the laboratory.		**Validated bi-annually, however Verification/Validation report not submitted, to further verify on site.**
7.11.3	Laboratory information management system (LIMS)			
a)	Protection from unauthorised access	• Access to the laboratory server (data drive) is restricted to management personnel only. All other staff members have limited user permissions preventing unauthorized access, modification, or deletion of data. Password protection and access control are in place, and user rights are reviewed periodically.		**Restricted to management only.** **Will this be a software programme for reporting results, if so why are technical signatories restricted?**

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b)	Safeguarding from tempering and loss	• All files on the server are backed up to an external hard drive on a monthly basis. Access to data and information is limited to management to prevent tampering. Backup integrity is verified regularly to ensure data recoverability.		**Only management has access.**
c)	Operated in environment that complies with specifications.	• The server and computer systems are located in a fixed, secure area. The environmental conditions of the analysis room and storage areas (temperature, humidity, and dust levels) are monitored and maintained within defined limits to prevent data corruption and equipment malfunction.		**To further verify on site.**
d)	Maintained to ensure the integrity of the data and information	• The information management system and related hardware are maintained according to the manufacturer's specifications. Regular system maintenance, software updates, antivirus protection, and integrity checks are conducted to ensure data accuracy and reliability. Any identified risks to data integrity are recorded and mitigated through preventive maintenance schedules		**Preventative maintenance done on schedule, to further verify on site the schedule as well as records generated.**

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e)	Record system failures and appropriate immediate and corrective actions.	• Any server, computer, or software malfunction is immediately reported to management. The incident is logged in the non-conformance register, including details of the failure, immediate containment actions taken, and corrective/preventive measures implemented. The system is not returned to operational use until functionality and data integrity are verified and approved by management.		**Preventative maintenance done on schedule, to further verify on site the schedule as well as records generated.**
7.11.4	LIMS managed and maintained off-site or through an external provider, the provider /operator must comply with the std.	• LIMS managed and maintained by an external provider. Also provides support as required.		**Backed up quarterly on a hard drive storage, backing up of the system is employed within the organisation.**
7.11.5	Instructions, manuals and reference data relevant to LIMS are readily available to personnel.	• There are no user manuals for LIMS, instead training is provided, and competency assessments are done to ensure personnel can operate it • The procedures on how to conduct each of the tests analysis are available upon request/		**No other additional procedures or manuals were submitted, to further verify on site.**
7.11.6	Calculations and data transfers subject to appropriate and systematic checks.	• LIMS Validation is done bi-annually, these calculations are verified independently by a second analyst		**To further verify on site.**
8	**MANAGEMENT SYSTEM REQUIREMENTS**			
8.1	**General**			
8.1.1	Establish, document, implement and maintain a management system			

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	Option A	• The CAB has adopted Option A and established a documented management system consistent with ISO/IEC 17025:2017. Policies, objectives, procedures and records form the backbone of this system • ASDP001 Quality Manual, 8.2 Quality Statement, Scope of work		**Where in the processes/procedures is the implementation of Option A of the management system addressed?**
	Option B	**N/A**		
8.2	**Management system documentation**			
8.2.1	Establish, document and maintain policies and objectives.	• The CAB maintains documented quality and operational policies, including competence, impartiality and quality objectives aligned with its accreditation scope.		**Addressed: Quality Policy Statement ASMS 8.2 -0.1 Rev 00**
8.2.2	Address competence, impartiality and consistent operation of the laboratory in policies and objectives.	• The policy explicitly commits to ensuring competent personnel, maintaining impartiality in all laboratory operations, and sustaining consistent processes across tests. • Quality Statement(8.2),		**Quality Policy Statement ASMS 8.2 -0.1 Rev 00 acknowledged 27-07-2025**

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8.2.3	Provide evidence of commitment to the development and implementation of the management system.	• Senior management signs off on the quality policy and allocates resources (staff, infrastructure, training) to support continuous system improvement. • Work instructions, checklists were developed, authorised and implemented. Competence records are available. Equipment maintenance records are available, etc. • The CAB was established in April 2025, the first management review will be held in January 2026; thereafter, annually.		**All management system documents are compiled and authorised by the Laboratory supervisor and Managing director. Only authorised personnel have access to the management system.**
8.2.4	All documentation, processes, systems, records; included, referenced or linked to the management system.	• All laboratory procedures, work instructions, forms, systems (including LIMS), and records are either part of, or referenced in, the management system. Document index and links ensure traceability(see doc ASDP001 Quality Manual)		**Accessed through QMWARELIMS 12 system folder.**
8.2.5	Access to the parts of the management system documents and related information by all personnel.	• Personnel have access (electronic and physical) to relevant portions of the management system. Controlled shared folders or intranet access ensure up-to-date versions are available at points of use.		**Accessed through QMWARELIMS 12 system folder.**
8.3	**Control of management system documents**			
8.3.1	Control of all internal and external documents.	• The CAB maintains document control over both internally generated and externally sourced documents (e.g. standards, method references). External documents are evaluated, approved, versioned, and integrated into the system.		**Addressed: Control of technical Records ASMF 7.16 Rev 00.** **A comprehensive document and record control system that governs both internally generated documents, to further confirm on site.** **Document Register Doc 6.3 R _ for internal documents only** **No register for documents of eternal origin.**

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8.3.2	Laboratory ensures:	• Documents are uniquely identified and approved by authorized personnel (e.g. Operations Manager). Periodic reviews take place as and when necessary. Changes and revisions are clearly marked on revision tables integrated within technical documents and SOP's. Current versions are distributed to points of use, and obsolete versions are stored in folders marked "Obsolete" to prevent unintended use. This applies to all sections a-f below see doc 7.16 Control of quality and technical records		
a)	Approval of documents by authorised personnel.			**Not addressed in the referred to procedure.**
b)	Periodic review and updating of documents.			**Not addressed in the referred to procedure**
c)	Changes and current revision status identified.			**Not addressed in the referred to procedure**
d)	Relevant revisions of documents are available at points of use and distribution is controlled.			**Not addressed in the referred to procedure**
e)	Unique identification.			**Not addressed in the referred to procedure**
f)	Obsolete documents are assured against unintended use and retained suitably marked.			**The system ensures that obsolete documents are promptly removed from points of use and archived with clear "Obsolete" markings to avoid unintended application, to be further verified on site.**

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8.4	**Control of Records**			
8.4.1	Establish and retain records.	• All records (technical, quality, training, audit, corrective) are created, stored, and retained in accordance with defined retention times and policies, see doc 7.16 Control of quality and technical records , section 7, Retention period.		**Addressed: Control of technical Records ASMF 7.16 Rev 00.** **Retention periods vary from 3- >10 years, not as per the regulator's contractual obligations.**
8.4.2	Implementation of controls for: identification, storage, protection, back up, archive, retrieve, retention time and disposal of records. For the period consistent with contractual obligations.	• Records are uniquely identified (e.g. numbering, metadata). Storage is secure (locked cabinets, restricted electronic access). Backups of electronic records are done quarterly. Archives are to be done at the end of each year, retrievable, and disposed of in line with contractual/legislative requirements • Storage, backup, archiving of technical documents will be in accordance to doc 7.16 Control of quality and technical records		• **Paper: Locked in cabinets and in limited-access areas- to further verify on site.** • **Digital: Password-protected folders, backup to secure servers.** • **Cloud-based: Must be encrypted, with restricted user roles.** • **Backup frequency- Quarterly.** • **Archiving of physical technical records are to be done at the end of each year, retrievable, and disposed of in line with contractual/legislative requirements, the retention periods vary rom 3 ->10 years, to further verify on site.**
8.5	**Action to address risks and opportunities**			
8.5.1	Consider risks and opportunity associated with the laboratory activities to: give assurance that the system achieves its intended results; Enhance opportunities to achieve the purpose and objectives of the laboratory; Prevent, or reduce, undesired impacts and potential failures and archive improvement.	• The CAB conducts risk assessments (technical, procedural, resource) to anticipate impacts on result validity, client service, and system performance, see doc 8.5. Actions to address risks and opportunities		**Risks and opportunities_ Not documented Process or procedure detailing how the risks and opportunities will be considered.** **i.e the submitted risk assessment does not give clarity on how risks are identified and assessed for further mitigating actions to be taken.**

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8.5.2	Plan actions to address risks and opportunities, how to integrate and implement the action into the system and evaluate effectiveness of actions.	• Mitigation and opportunity plans are incorporated into the system with controls to risks and consequences and each having an assigned personnel to implement and review effectiveness of corrective actions, also covered in doc 8.5. Actions to address risks and opportunities		
8.5.3	Action taken proportional to the potential impact on validity of lab results.	• Actions (e.g. calibrations, verifications) are scaled to cover criticality of each process, equipment calibrations performed annually since its covered by metrologically audited service provider and verified weekly to address criticality, inhouse calibration as and when necessary(CV).		
8.6	**Improvement**			
8.6.1 Note Std	Identify, select and implement opportunities for improvement.	• Continuous improvement opportunities are identified via audits, corrective actions, performance indicators, customer feedback, and management reviews, then implemented appropriately.		**Which procedure/ process identifies opportunities for improvements, and how does the laboratory plan to implement these listed opportunities?**
8.6.2 Note Std	Getting feedback from customer. Analysing and using feedback to improve the management system, laboratory activities and customer service.	• Client feedback is formally collected and reviewed periodically (biannually); actionable changes are fed back into system updates and process modifications. • There is also a survey form AS006MF which is used for reviews by customers.		**Which procedure/process details how customer feedback will be obtained from clients. How does the lab further on analyse results of these feedback for improvement purposes?**
8.7	**Corrective action**			
8.7.1	When a non-conformity occurs:			

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a)	React to a non-conformity (take action to control and correct, address the consequences)	• When a nonconformity (NC) is identified; whether through internal audit findings, customer complaints, proficiency testing failures, equipment breakdowns, or deviations from approved procedures; the responsible personnel immediately record it using a Nonconformity Register (NCR) form. Immediate containment and control actions are taken to prevent further impact (e.g., isolating affected samples, suspending analysis, or withholding reports). Any potential effects on previously released data are evaluated, and clients are notified if validity may be affected. • Documentation used: AS007MF, 8.7.3.		**Addressed: Management of non-conforming work: ASFM 7.17 Rev 00.** **Immediate action will be initiated.**
b)	Evaluate the need to eliminate the cause.	• Root cause analysis (RCA) is conducted using structured techniques such as 5 Whys, Ishikawa (fishbone) diagrams, or other systematic problem-solving tools. The investigation considers technical, procedural, equipment, and human factors to determine the underlying cause and assess whether additional actions are required to prevent recurrence. • Forms used: AS001MF, AS002MF, AS003MF, SANAS F 03-09,		**Root cause analysis not adequately addressed in the procedure. Does the laboratory have a separate procedure/process detailing how the cause will be eliminated?**

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c)	Implement action	• Based on the RCA findings, corrective actions are implemented. These actions may include procedure revision, staff retraining, equipment recalibration or maintenance, or process redesign. • Responsibilities, target dates, and verification steps are documented in the corrective action log.		**No implementation timeline addressed.**
d)	Review effectiveness of corrective action taken.	• Effectiveness is evaluated after implementation to confirm that the corrective action eliminated the root cause and did not introduce new risks. Follow-up verification may include internal audit checks, review of subsequent results, or trend analysis of similar incidents. • Effectiveness reviews are signed off by the Operations Manager or designated responsible person.		• **How does the laboratory plan to review the effectiveness of the corrective action.** • **When will this process take place? (timeline)**
e)	Update risks and opportunities, if necessary.	• When applicable, the laboratory updates its Risk and Opportunity Register to reflect lessons learned from the nonconformity. Changes in risk level or new preventive measures are recorded, ensuring integration into the broader risk management framework. • Docs: 8.5. Actions to address risks and opportunities		**Risk matrix used to evaluate severity and urgency, *to further verify on site with the actual completed incident report*.**

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f)	Make changes to the management system, if necessary.	• If a nonconformity reveals systemic weaknesses, the Operations Manager ensures that related procedures, SOPs, or forms are revised accordingly. Revisions are controlled through the document control process (Clause 8.3), reviewed, approved, and communicated to all affected personnel. Where appropriate, changes are reviewed during management review meetings to ensure ongoing system suitability and effectiveness.		**Not addressed in the procedure.**
8.7.2	Appropriate corrective actions.	• Corrective actions are carefully chosen to address root causes rather than symptoms, and documented with responsibilities and timelines, implementation outlined in doc SANAS F 03-09		**Not addressed in the procedure.**
8.7.3	Retain records (nature of NC, cause(s), subsequent actions taken and results of any corrective action)			**No corrective action records were referred to in the procedure, to further verify on site.**
8.8	**Internal audits**			
8.8.1	At planned intervals conduct internal audits. Verify that systems conform to lab's requirements and the standard and it is implemented.	• Audit of the system is planned for Nov-Dec 2026. This will be the very first comprehensive audit program, given that the company has been business for ~7 months. Please see the audit programme doc AUI001-INTERNAL AUDIT PLAN FOR 2026 • This audit programme is comprehensive and thus covers 8.81-8.8.2 (a-e)		**Addressed: Internal Audits Procedure ASFM 8.7 Rev 00, planned annually.**
8.8.2 a)	Plan, establish, implement and maintain audit programme.			**Internal audit Schedule/plan/Schedule (Not a controlled document)**

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b)	Define for each audit: criteria and scope	• ASMF 8.7 Internal Audit procedure, was implemented and require that Lead auditor (who may be independent expect or management team member) shall define the criteria and scope of internal audit.		**Audit scope: Phases 1-3 (1. Testing activities, 2. Technical and management requirements and PT schemes, and 3. Finalization)** **Audit criteria: Not addressed.**
c)	Results of the audit reported to relevant management.	• ASMF 8.7 Internal Audit procedure, States that the audit findings shall be shared with all personnel in the organisation. • ASDP001 management system document require that audit finding be also shared at management review meeting.		**Results of the audits communicated through an audit report, distributed to all members within 12 working days.** **No audit report submitted, *to further verify on site*.**
d)	Implement corrective actions without undue delay.	• ASMF 8.7 Internal Audit procedure section "conducting internal audit" **require that** Major NC shall be addressed within 24 hours; Minor NC shall be addressed within 72 hours		**No implementation date addressed in the refereed to procedure.**
e)	Audit records.	• ASMF 8.7 Internal Audit procedure states that the Lead Auditor shall write and share the audit report within 12 working days. • ASMF 8.7.3 Improvement action request is used to state the objective evidence of finding and corrective action.		**No audit records were referred to in the procedure, to further verify on site.**
8.9	**Management reviews**			

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8.9.1	Review laboratory's management system at planned intervals to ensure their continuing suitability, adequacy and effectiveness.	• Given that the lab was recently established, there has not yet been a management review meeting yet. However, the lab has a procedure in place on how it will go about doing it's management reviews and what sections of the standard to look at. The details of the review will be geared towards all the information outlined in 8.9.2. (a-f) and as stipulated by internal management review procedure doc ASMF8.6		**Addressed: Management review Procedure: ASFM 8.6 Rev 00.** **Management reviews conducted annually** **Not all minimum agenda points are addressed in the ASFM 8.6, such as:** • ***Fulfilment of laboratory Objectives*** • ***Changes in the volume and type of work*** • ***Suitability of procedures and policies*** • ***Assessments by other external bodies***
8.9.2	Review of: changes in internal and external issues relevant to the laboratory; fulfilment of objectives; suitability of policies and procedures; status of actions from previous management reviews; outcome of recent internal audits; corrective actions; assessments by external bodies; changes in volume & type of work; customer and personnel feedback, complaints, improvements; resources, results of risk id, outcomes of assurance of the validity of results, monitoring activities and training.	• Given that the lab was recently established, there has not yet been a management review meeting yet. However, the lab has a procedure in place on how it will go about doing it's management reviews and what sections of the standard to look at. The details of the review will be geared towards all the information outlined in 8.9.2. (a-f) and as stipulated by internal management review procedure doc ASMF8.6		**Minutes of the meeting will be logged on the Management Review meeting ASTR 8.6 Rev 00, however the minimum agenda points are all logged on the ASTR 8.6.** **No actual minutes submitted, *to further verify on site*.**
8.9.3	Record all decisions and actions: the effectiveness of the management system, improvement of the lab activities, provision of requires resources and any need for change.	• To be done during the first management review		• **New Action list** • **Decision on the effectiveness of the management system,** ***to further verify on site with the actual meeting minutes*.**
Additional / General Comments *This space may also be used to expand on comments in specific sections*				

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Additional / General Comments *This space may also be used to expand on comments in specific sections*

Team Leader's Signature:	**Ms Charmaine Morobe** 	**Date:**	**29-10-2026**

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